

First Read

European MedTech

Dragons at the gate: new VBP proposals raise further China risk

Equities

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Healthcare

New proposals could further pressure price and market shares for western players

Earlier today, China's National Health Commission (NHC), together with two other regulatory bodies, issued a notice aimed at further enhancing volume-based procurement (VBP) across public healthcare institutions. The proposals would expand VBP into medical equipment—particularly capital equipment—which has largely been excluded from the programme to date. In our view, this expansion could increase pricing pressure and lead to further market share shifts away from multinational suppliers. We see Elekta (Sell) and GE Healthcare (Neutral) as the most exposed, while Siemens Healthineers (Neutral) and Philips (Buy) also face potential risk, albeit to a lesser extent.

Note, we are hosting a call with our China team today at 2pm UKT, to join please register [here](#)

What has happened?

Earlier today, the Chinese National Health Commission (NHC), along with two other regulatory authorities, issued a notice on further improving volume-based procurement (VBP) of medical equipment by public healthcare institutions. In this announcement it outlined plans to expand VBP (volume based procurement) across medical equipment and specifically, capital equipment, a category that has been for the most part not included in VBP to date. We think this announcement has negative consequences for western radiotherapy and imaging players.

What is being outlined?

The announcements broadly cover three areas:

- **A three tier framework for VBP:** Firstly, Class A large scale equipment (certain radiotherapy equipment and any first time installed medical device above RMB50m) will now be included in national VBP. Secondly, Provincial CVP will now include Class B large-scale medical equipment such as PET-CT, PET-MR, laparoscopic surgical robots and conventional RT equipment with other high value medical equipment being added over time. Thirdly, Municipal VBP will include medical equipment outside of the scope for the above with all provinces required to complete one round of VBP by the end of 2026.
- **Transparent pricing:** The notice proposes to establish a national filing database for high-value medical equipment to improve products' price transparency.
- **Bid evaluation criteria.** The notice highlighted that the bid evaluation will be conducted from the perspectives of product quality, services and price, with the cost of consumables and maintenance being taken into consideration.

How could this impact radiotherapy players (Elekta, Siemens Healthineers)?

Overall implications: National VBP includes high-end radiotherapy platforms (MR-linacs and Accuray's Cyberknife device), while provincial VBP includes conventional RT systems (we believe most of Varian and Elekta's platforms would fall into this category).

Varian (SHL) – neutral to negative: We estimate China is <10% of divisional revenues. While we do not think any platforms are covered by National VBP, we believe flagship platform Truebeam and Halcyon could fall under provincial VBP. We see competition here from local player United Imaging, which aside from a very competitive

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flagship diagnostic CT platform also sells a Halcyon-like O-ring linac in China; that said, most of Varian's revenue growth over the past few years has been and we expect will continue to be driven by the US.

Elekta – negative: China is 13% of group revenues and management guides for mid-single-digit revenue growth here over FY26-FY29, listing "Expand in China" as a key strategic pillar. We think this will be materially harder to achieve as (a) national VBP covers Elekta's MR-linac Unity, for which there is no significant local competition but risk that price cuts of the kind we have seen in provincial procurement for other large-scale medical equipment (e.g. 45% for CT in Q1) could erode most of its high profitability; (2) provincial VBP covers most of the rest of its portfolio, including Evo, for which there is significant local competition, notably from United Imaging. Elekta is currently the largest player in China conventional RT (c.40% market share), and hence we believe is likely a key share donor.

How could this affect imaging players (GE Healthcare, Philips and Siemens Healthineers)?

From the above, we believe there is greater risk of expansion of VBP at some level (municipal or provincial) to encompass most of imaging. We have seen some encroachment of VBP (non national level) into CT, MRI and ultrasound over the past 12 months, but this has been limited typically to low end devices. Such an expansion could further pressure pricing and potentially drive share losses for western players. We believe GE Healthcare (Neutral) is most exposed here given its greater revenue share in China as well as our view that its portfolio is more comparable with local players United Imaging and Mindray. Siemens Healthineers is next most exposed though its innovation helps to provide some buffer. Philips (Buy) is then next most exposed as although it competes more directly with Mindray and United Imaging in the ultrasound categories, it has the least total revenue exposure and its imaging portfolio has some differentiation particularly in Image Guided Therapy.

Valuation:

Our PTs are DCF derived.

Valuation Method and Risk Statement

Risks generally applicable to the healthcare sector include the following: development risk: uncertainty regarding the timing, efficacy, and market potential of new products and technologies; commercial risk: threats from new/existing competition, pricing pressure; regulatory risk: timing/status of approvals, changes in labelling or new earnings on existing products and technologies; patent risk: products losing patent protection may face significant market share/price erosion, potential litigation; currency risk: due to the mismatch between geographic location of cost-base and sales. We use DCF valuations for all of our EU coverage.

Elekta: We value Elekta using a DCF with a 9.4% WACC and a terminal growth rate of 1.5%, which is in line with our assumptions for companies in other Medtech industries facing significant volume headwinds. Key risks to our thesis include: uptick in radiotherapy prescriptions in developed world; capex tailwinds in EMs; correction of reimbursement asymmetries in the US. Broader risks to the operating model include reimbursement, improving alternative (drug) therapies and lengthening of product replacement cycles.

Siemens Healthineers: In addition to general healthcare industry risks (volume, pricing, regulatory) and the risks associated with international operations (FX, geopolitical), Siemens Healthineers' business mix is somewhat more exposed to the healthcare capex cycle. Company-specific risks include (1) the failure of Attellicato drive a Diagnostics turnaround, (2) hospital, lab, and other customer consolidation, (3) minority shareholder risks, given Siemens AG remains the majority shareholder, and (4) inability to keep pace with industry innovation. Our price target for Siemens Healthineers is DCF derived assuming a WACC of 8.2% and terminal growth of 1.75%.

GE Healthcare: We use a DCF valuation to value GE Healthcare Technologies, assuming a WACC of 9.0%, TG 1.5%. Key upside risks to our assumptions include the following: 1) Flyrcado launch accelerates beyond our and sellside estimates. 2) PCCT launch drives rapid uptake and share gains, lifting Imaging margins in the process. 3) Chinese competitors do not gain ground through their internationalization. 4) GEHC new product launches drive share gains in core imaging and ultrasound businesses. 5) Alzheimer's developments drive an acceleration in demand for Pharmaceutical Diagnostics and also for equipment used to diagnose and monitor the disease. 6) Management continues to deliver cost savings beyond the initial IPO-related reduction in transaction services agreements. Downside risks to GE Healthcare include: 1) Hospital capex: there is a risk that hospital budgets could be lowered due to macro concerns, and lead to a decline in the purchasing of capital equipment. 2) Execution risk from spin-off: an IPO or spin-off can pose a meaningful distraction to a business and especially to management, at least in the short term. 3) Regulation: healthcare reforms across major geographies could negatively impact the company's financials.

Philips: Philips' earnings are cyclical by nature. Our estimates and price target are thus sensitive to changes in expectations for global and regional growth. Other key risks include: 1) Whether management can transition Philips towards growth yet maintain control over asset growth to maximise shareholder returns. 2) Change in regulations affecting healthcare spending. 3) Material fluctuation in retailer inventories. 4) Volatility with raw material costs and foreign exchange rates. 5) New product launches gaining/not gaining traction in the market. 6) Lower/higher-than-expected growth in key emerging markets. Valuation: Our price target is DCF derived using a WACC of 7.5% and a terminal growth rate of 1.5%.

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Buy	FSR is > 6% above the MRA.	55%	24%
Neutral	FSR is between -6% and 6% of the MRA.	40%	21%
Sell	FSR is > 6% below the MRA.	6%	21%

Source: UBS. Rating allocations are as of 30 June 2026.

1:Percentage of companies under coverage globally within the 12-month rating category.

2:Percentage of companies within the 12-month rating category for which investment banking (IB) services were provided within the past 12 months.

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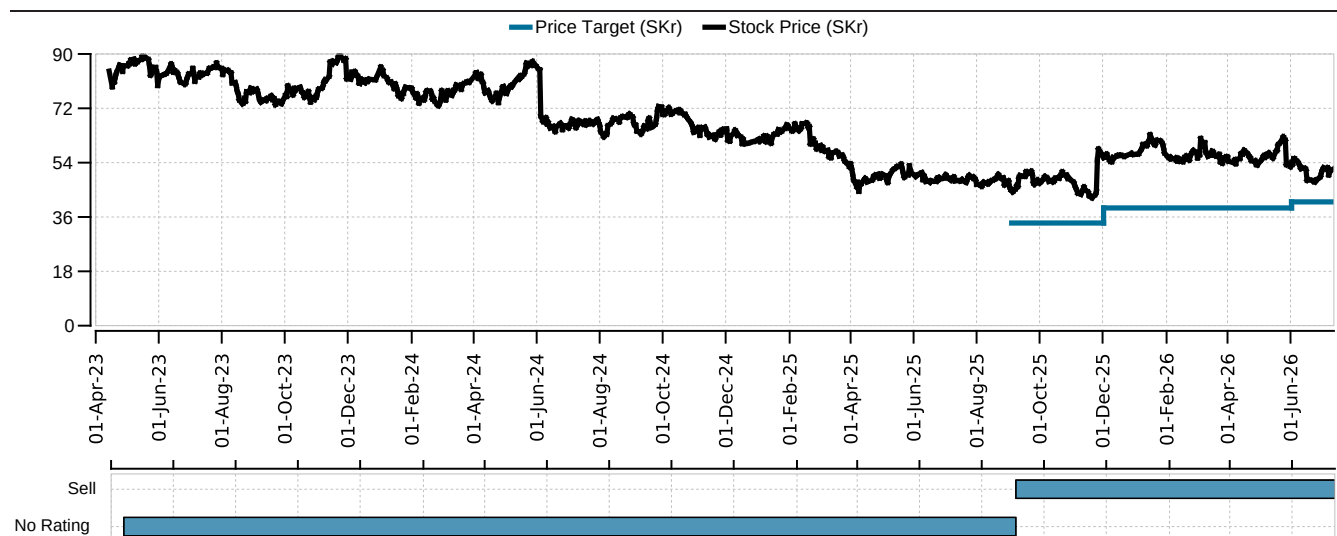
Company Name	Reuters	12-month rating	Price	Price date
Elekta AB ²⁸	EKTA.B.ST	Sell	SKr52.00	13 Jul 2026
GE Healthcare Technologies Inc ^{4,16,6,28}	GEHC.O	Neutral	US\$65.31	13 Jul 2026
Koninklijke Philips N.V. ^{4,16,6,28,7}	PHG.AS	Buy	€24.09	13 Jul 2026
Siemens Healthineers AG ²⁸	SHLG.DE	Neutral	€35.56	13 Jul 2026

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon. All prices as of local market close. Ratings in this table are the most current published ratings prior to this report. They may be more recent than the stock pricing date.

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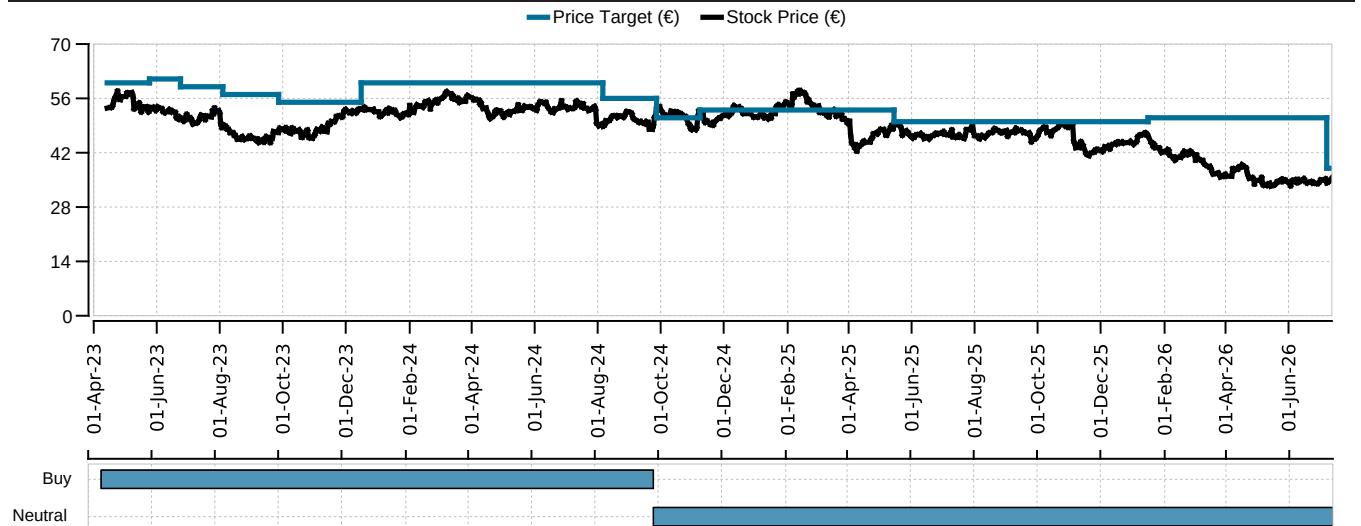
Elekta AB (SKr)



Date	Stock Price (SKr)	Price Target (SKr)	Rating
2023-04-13	84.64	-	No Rating
2025-09-03	45.10	34.00	Sell
2025-12-01	56.45	39.00	Sell
2026-06-01	52.65	41.00	Sell

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon as of 13-Jul-2026. All prices as of local market close. Ratings as of date shown.

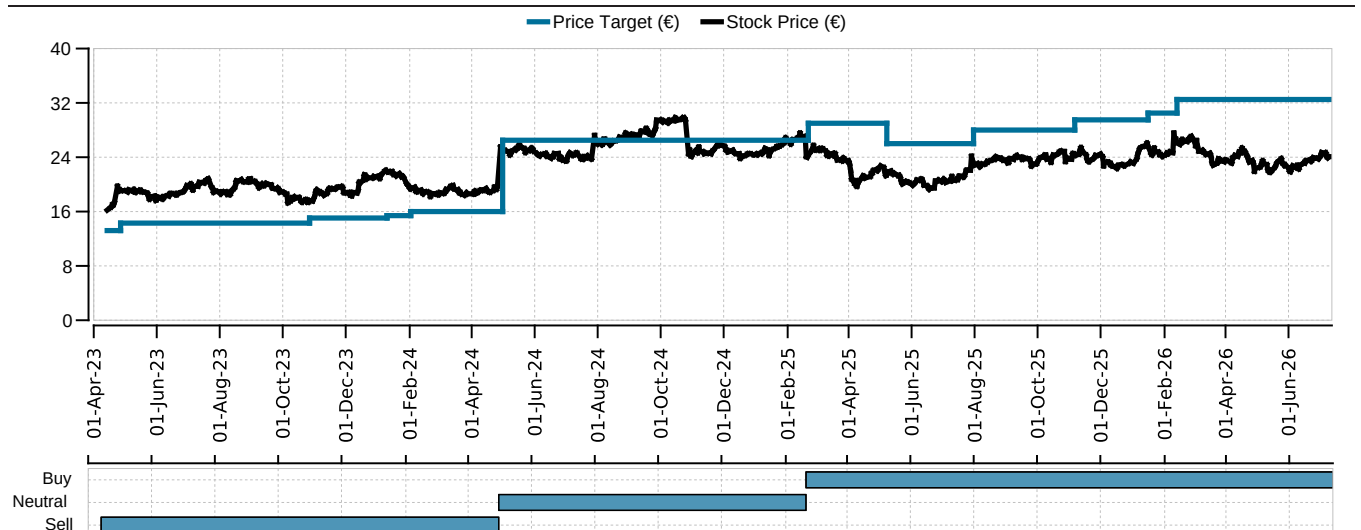
Siemens Healthineers AG (€)



Date	Stock Price (€)	Price Target (€)	Rating
2023-04-13	54.18	60.00	Buy
2023-05-24	52.52	61.00	Buy
2023-06-23	51.24	59.00	Buy
2023-08-03	48.50	57.00	Buy
2023-09-26	47.32	55.00	Buy
2023-12-15	53.30	60.00	Buy
2024-08-05	49.42	56.00	Buy
2024-09-26	51.30	51.00	Neutral
2024-11-07	52.78	53.00	Neutral
2025-05-14	48.15	50.00	Neutral
2026-01-15	46.80	51.00	Neutral
2026-07-07	35.25	38.00	Neutral

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon as of 13-Jul-2026. All prices as of local market close. Ratings as of date shown.

Koninklijke Philips N.V (€)

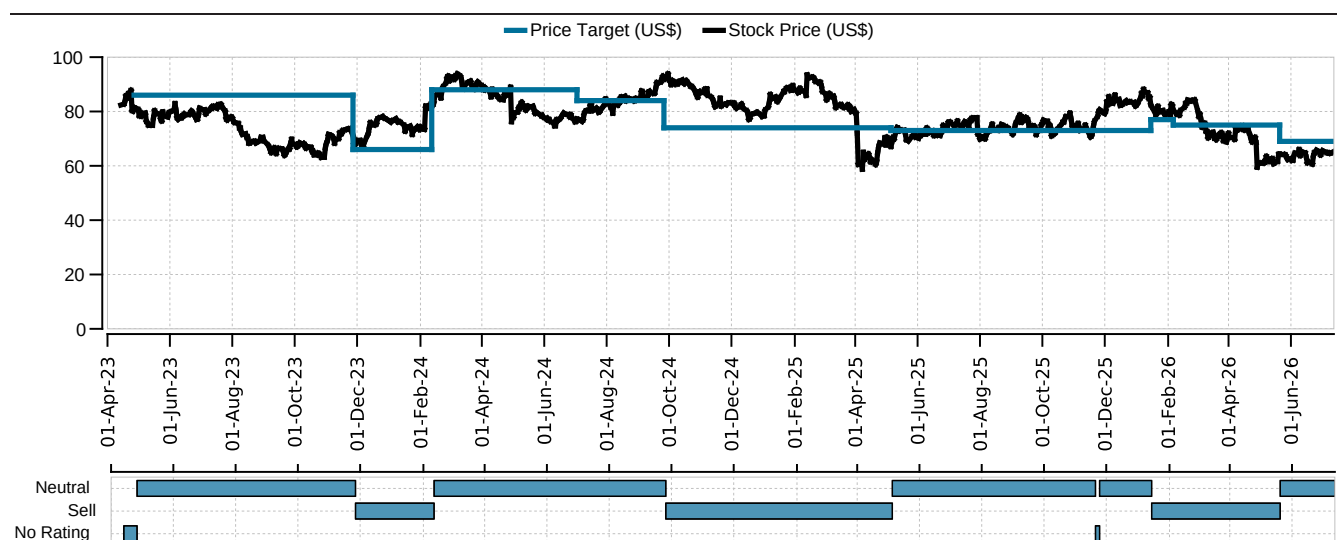


Date	Stock Price (€)	Price Target (€)	Rating
2023-04-13	16.78	13.20	Sell
2023-04-26	19.05	14.30	Sell
2023-10-26	17.40	15.05	Sell
2024-01-09	22.06	15.40	Sell

Date	Stock Price (€)	Price Target (€)	Rating
2024-02-01	19.46	16.00	Sell
2024-04-30	25.25	26.50	Neutral
2025-02-20	24.00	29.00	Buy
2025-05-07	21.30	26.00	Buy
2025-07-30	23.53	28.00	Buy
2025-11-05	24.36	29.50	Buy
2026-01-15	26.08	30.50	Buy
2026-02-12	26.65	32.50	Buy

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon as of 13-Jul-2026. All prices as of local market close. Ratings as of date shown.

GE Healthcare Technologies Inc (US\$)



Date	Stock Price (US\$)	Price Target (US\$)	Rating
2023-04-13	82.94	-	No Rating
2023-04-26	80.12	86.00	Neutral
2023-11-26	73.71	66.00	Sell
2024-02-11	81.34	88.00	Neutral
2024-07-02	76.33	84.00	Neutral
2024-09-25	93.01	74.00	Sell
2025-05-05	69.37	73.00	Neutral
2025-11-20	74.75	-	No Rating
2025-11-24	78.24	73.00	Neutral
2026-01-14	85.30	77.00	Sell
2026-02-05	82.31	75.00	Sell
2026-05-20	64.26	69.00	Neutral

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon as of 13-Jul-2026. All prices as of local market close. Ratings as of date shown.

Additional Prices: Shenzhen Mindray Bio-Medical Electronics, Rmb139.96 (14 Jul 2026); Shanghai United Imaging Healthcare, Rmb110.21 (14 Jul 2026); Carl Zeiss Meditec AG, €31.56 (13 Jul 2026); Source: UBS. All prices as of local market close.

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